Test A – Foundation (topics 01–04)

AI Training for Beginners

Self-study training: use AI/LLMs safely in everyday life

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File: `test_A_foundation.md`

https://github.com/mgunthner/AI-Training

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Test A – Foundation (topics 01–04)

Scope: 19 questions · **Points:** 24 · **Pass mark 75 %:** 18 points

How the test works

- The test shows you what has stuck and what you should review. It is not a certificate.
- Work without the cheatsheets. That way you see what you have really retained.
- Write down your answers (on paper or in a note file) before looking at the solutions.
- The solutions are separate: `03_tests/test_A_foundation_solutions`. Only look at them once you're done.
- You grade practical tasks and safety checks yourself using the self-assessment rubric (`self_assessment`) – criterion by criterion.
- No time limit. All examples contain only fictional data.

Topics 01 – What is AI?

Question 1 · Multiple choice · 1 point What describes a language model (LLM) best? - A) A database of verified facts - B) A program that produces text by predicting likely-fitting next pieces of text - C) A digital human who thinks like you - D) A search engine with its own archive

Question 2 · True/False with reasoning · 1 point "If an AI answer sounds very convincing and detailed, it is very likely correct." True or false? Explain in one sentence. (1 point only for the correct verdict plus reasoning.)

Question 3 · Multiple choice (several correct) · 2 points Which tasks are typical strengths of a chatbot? Choose all correct answers. - A) Rephrasing a text - B) Summarizing a long email - C) Reliably reporting current events without web search - D) Delivering exact source references that you don't need to check - E) Collecting ideas for a birthday party

(2 points for a completely correct selection, 1 point for exactly one mistake, otherwise 0.)

Question 4 · Multiple choice · 1 point What, in principle, distinguishes a chatbot from a classic search engine? - A) There is no difference. - B) The chatbot automatically checks every statement against original sources. - C) The chatbot formulates

answers anew; the search engine lists existing webpages. - D) The search engine can only find images.

Question 5 · Scenario · 1 point You ask an AI without web search about the result of yesterday's game. It confidently names a result. What makes the most sense? - A) You believe it, because it sounds confident. - B) You ask the question several times and take the most frequent answer. - C) You start a new chat and ask again. - D) You turn on web search or check the result with a reliable source.

Topic 02 – Tokens & context window

Question 6 · Multiple choice · 1 point What is a token? - A) A small piece of text in which the AI processes text - B) A password for the AI service - C) A page of text - D) A tariff plan at the provider

Question 7 · True/False with reasoning · 1 point "The context window only covers your current message, not the previous conversation." True or false? Explain in one sentence.

Question 8 · Scenario · 1 point You have been planning several topics in the same chat for a long time. The AI is becoming less accurate and ignoring your instructions. What do you do? - A) You repeat the most important instruction five times in capital letters. - B) You have the current state summarized, check it, and continue in a new chat. - C) You keep writing in the same chat and hope the AI pulls itself together. - D) You ask why it is ignoring you and wait for an explanation.

Question 9 · Practical task · 2 points Write a prompt that has a long chat summarized for a new chat. It should - (a) limit the length and - (b) name which content is important.

(1 point per fulfilled criterion. Check your solution against the model answer.)

Topic 03 – Model selection & free plans

Question 10 · Multiple choice · 1 point You want a sentence in an email phrased more politely. Which approach fits best? - A) The largest available model with maximum reasoning effort - B) None at all, because AI can't write emails - C) A smaller, faster model is usually enough - D) A model that uses as many tokens as possible

Question 11 · Multiple choice (several correct) · 2 points What do free plans typically restrict? Choose all correct answers. - A) Access to certain models - B) The amount of usage per period - C) Some features - D) The basic ability to write texts - E) The right to anonymize chats

(2 points for a completely correct selection, 1 point for exactly one mistake, otherwise 0.)

Question 12 · True/False with reasoning · 1 point "The largest model is the best choice for every task." True or false? Explain in one sentence.

Question 13 · Scenario · 1 point You have an AI check an anonymized contract text for notice periods. The decision has financial consequences. What is sensible? - A) Use a more powerful model and check the result against the original text - B) Use

the smallest model and adopt the answer unchecked - C) Ask the same question five times and take the most frequent answer - D) Adopt the answer if it sounds thorough

Question 14 · Practical task · 2 points Assign: Is a **small** model (K) enough, or is a **larger** model or thinking mode (G) more sensible? 1. Translate a sentence into English 2. Correct spelling mistakes in a short email 3. Develop a multi-stage travel plan with budget, connection times and rainy-day alternatives 4. Find contradictions in a long, anonymized report

(4 correct assignments = 2 points, 3 correct = 1 point, otherwise 0.)

Topic 04 – Data privacy in everyday life

Question 15 · Multiple choice · 1 point Which input is the least problematic? - A) A photo of your ID card so the AI can fill out a form - B) A list with names and email addresses of your company's customers - C) Your online banking password so the AI can help you log in - D) A fictional email with "Person A" and "Company X" for practice

Question 16 · Safety check · 2 points Find the mistakes in this prompt (all details fictional):

```
Write a friendly rejection letter to Mr. Anton Sample,
Main Street 1, 00000 Sampletown, who applied as an accountant at
Sample Ltd. His mobile number is 0000 000000. He mentioned that
he has diabetes.
```

(a) Name at least three details that do not belong in the chat. (1 point)
(b) Rewrite the prompt so that it is anonymized but still works. (1 point)

Question 17 · True/False with reasoning · 1 point "When I upload a screenshot, the AI only sees what I deliberately wanted to show." True or false? Explain in one sentence.

Question 18 · Scenario · 1 point You want to summarize an internal document with customer data from your office using AI. You don't know whether your employer allows this. What do you do? - A) You use your private account, because it's faster. - B) You clarify it first with your superiors or the data protection officer and use the company account, if one exists. - C) You only leave out the names, then everything is allowed. - D) You upload it and delete the chat afterwards.

Question 19 · Multiple choice · 1 point Which measure reduces the risk that your inputs are used for training? - A) Turning off training use in the settings, if your service offers that - B) Starting every message with the word "confidential" - C) Renaming the chat - D) Activating dark mode

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Scoring

Count your points using the solutions file. - **18–24 points:** passed - **0–17 points:** not passed yet. The solutions show you which topics you should review. After that, you can retake the test.